

4. You can request a new appraisal. If you feel the appraiser made mistakes or did not perform the appraisal properly, check in with your lender to see whether they'd be willing to have another appraisal performed. Yes, you'll have to pay for this new one too. (Note that this is not an option for FHA or VA loans.)

The good news is that most properties meet their appraised value, especially if you're going into the purchase with an understanding of what a "good" deal really is. If you're taking our earlier advice, you're not going to make an offer that is any higher than the home's actual value, and you have already done work very similar to what an appraiser does. You and your agent have reviewed comparable properties before making your offer, almost like an unofficial mini-appraisal. It's the exception and not the rule when the appraisal causes a fuss, but it does happen from time to time.

WHILE YOU WAIT

After you've submitted your inspection objection notice and delivered all the documents to your lender, there's a lot of hurry up and wait. While a lot needs to be done between now and closing, there's also a lot of downtime. It's the perfect opportunity to wring your hands and pace around the room, hoping everything goes well.

Make a point to check your email every day, at least three times a day, to make sure you're not missing something important in the purchase process. Keep your phone charged and check voicemail frequently so you don't miss any important requests from your lender. Check in with your lender once a week to make sure they're not waiting on something from you that you somehow missed.

Pack your stuff. It takes a lot longer than you think. Make an "Open First" box that contains a roll of toilet paper for each bathroom, a roll of paper towels, soap, shampoo, toothpaste and sheets for each bed. Buy a new lock for the front and back doors so you can install them after you close. Buy a bulk pack of 9-volt batteries so you can update the smoke detectors.

And then, you wait. Try not to pace a trail into the floor.